AN EXPRESSWAY OF GROWTH ON THE L

Roads reflect the development of any region. The double engine government is fulfilling the dream of development which the people of Bundelkhand saw after independence. Prime Minister Narendra Modi opened the Vista of development by inaugurating the Bundelkhand Expressway on 16 July in Jalaun when the nation is celebrating azadi ka Amrit mahotsav. Prime Minister Narendra Modi congratulated the people of Bundelkhand and Uttar Pradesh for the inauguration of modern Bundelkhand Expressway and said that this Expressway is dedicated to the glorious tradition of Bundelkhand. Good governance is a prerequisite of development. The Yogi Adityanath government in Uttar Pradesh has created the environment of good governance that is why the 296 km long Bundelkhand Expressway was completed in mere 28 months. There is no other instance of completing a 300 km long expressway in less than 2.5 years. Bundelkhand Expressway is giving impetus to the growth of development.

The dreams of Development of more than 1 crore population got wings with the starting of Bundelkhand Expressway which starts from Chitrakoot and after passing through Banda Mahoba Hamirpur Jalaun and Auraiya ends in Etawah. Yogi Adityanath reached at the helm of affairs in Uttar Pradesh in March 2017 and after 1 month on 20 April 2017, Yogi visited Jhansi district. During this visit Yogi Adityanath announced that Bundelkhand will be connected to Delhi. While returning from Jhansi to Lucknow, Yogi Adityanath directed senior IAS officer and CEO of Uttar Pradesh express industrial Development authority, Awanish Kumar Awasthi to prepare a work plan for construction of Bundelkhand Expressway. After that UPEIDA took the responsibility of turning the dream of Bundelkhand Expressway into reality. The work plan of Bundelkhand Expressway was approved during the cabinet meeting held in Prayagraj Kumbh in 2019 under the chairmanship of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath. Next year on 29th February 2020 Prime Minister Narendra Modi laid the foundation stone of Bundelkhand expressway in Chitrakoot. Facing the challenges of three waves of covid, the construction of Bundelkhand Expressway was completed after 28 months of the foundation stone laying ceremony. Earlier the target to complete the construction work was 36 months and the time frame was February 2023, but UPEIDA made a record by completing it 7 months before the scheduled target.

Bundelkhand Expressway is the fastest made Expressway in the country.

The reason behind completion of the construction of Bundelkhand expressway in a record time, is the availability of the land for the project on a very short notice. UPEIDA managed to arrange 95% of the total required land for the Expressway within 6 months in 2019. UPEIDA prepared a website for direct monitoring of the land acquisition process. With the help of this website, CEO Awanish Awasthi monitored the

> "The new Expressway will not only increase the speed of vehicles of the whole Bundelkhand region but will also accelerate the industrial growth. Industries will be established on both sides of Bundelkhand Expressway. Defence industrial corridor will also benefit from this Expressway. The Bundelkhand Expressway will connect each and every region of Bundelkhand with development, self employment and new avenues."
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> *— Prime Minister Narendra Modi.*



